

Reimagining the Customer Journey:

A Strategic UX Research Initiative for FanDuel's Payment Experience

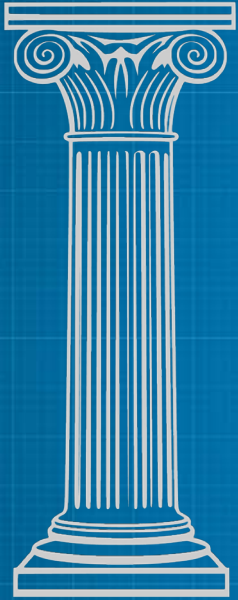
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*“We want to be one of the most trusted brands
in all of sports & entertainment.”*

– Amy Howe, Fanduel CEO



FanDuel's 2025-26 business goals

Improve customer satisfaction and trust

Improve acquisition and retention

SATISFACTION

TRUST

User Research response

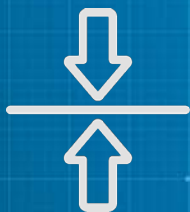
Establish clear baselines for payment transactions

Fix critical usability and perception issues

USABILITY

PHASE 1

Establish
Baselines



PHASE 2

Pinpoint
Pain Points



PHASE 3

Model
Solutions

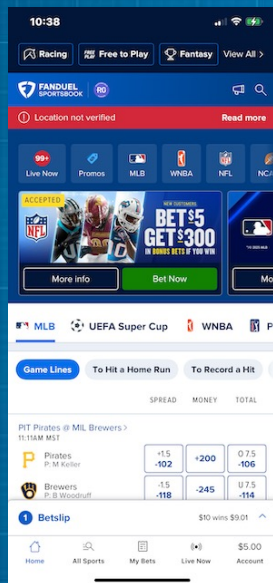
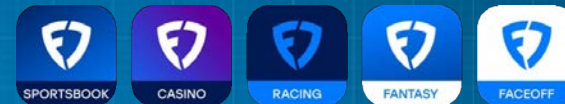


PHASE 4

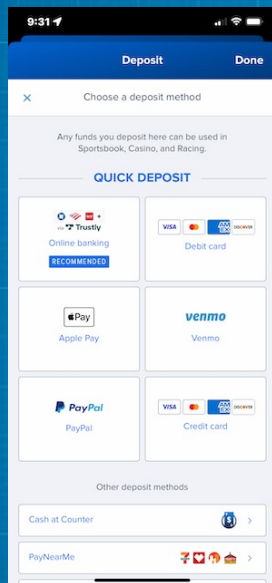
Monitor
Success
Metrics



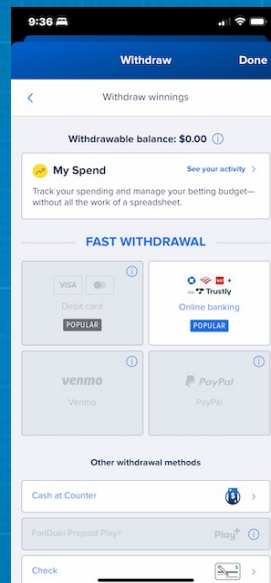
PAYMENT LANDSCAPE



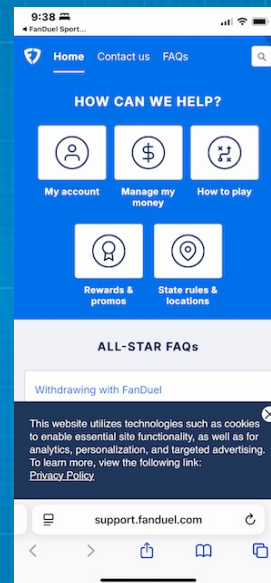
SPORTSBOOK



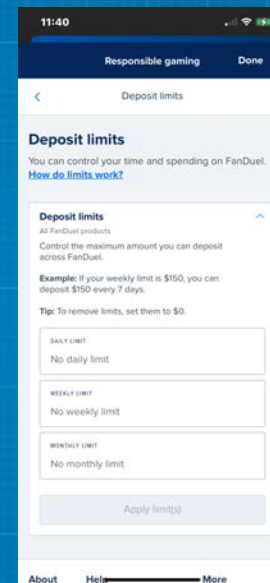
DEPOSITS



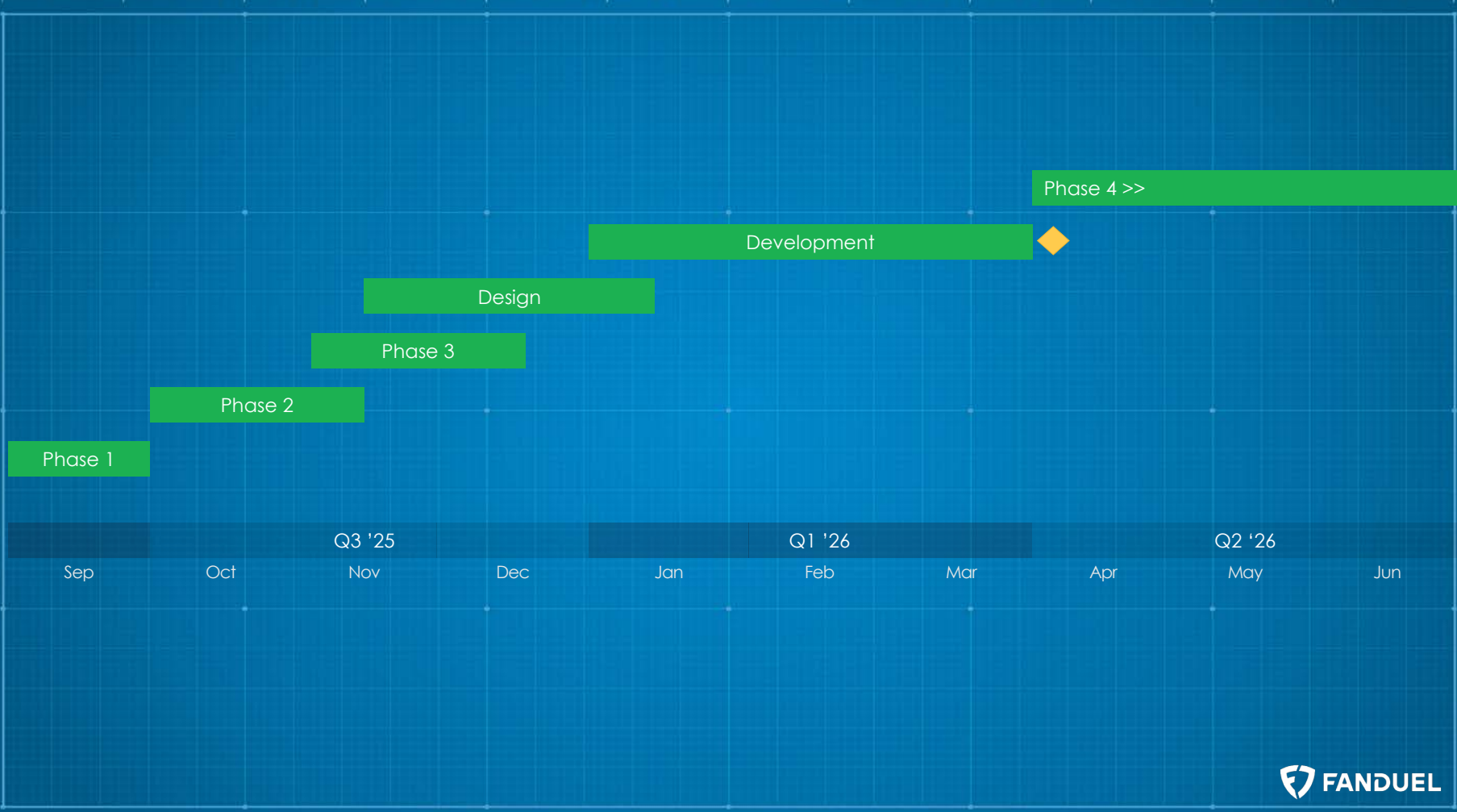
WITHDRAWALS



CUSTOMER SUPPORT



RESPONSIBLE GAMING



FOUNDATIONS

ASSUMPTIONS

1. All use cases take place in FanDuel digital products
2. Current U.S. audiences in relevant states
3. Account system for Sportsbook, Casino, and Racing, deposit wallet for Fantasy and Faceoff.
4. 2-3 Researchers

AUDIENCE SEGMENTATION

1. Brand properties
2. Platforms
3. Game preferences
4. Gambling style
5. Betting experience
6. Customer longevity
7. Demographics
8. Geographic location

TOOLS

1. Google Analytics
2. Salesforce
3. App Store Connect
4. Google Play Console
5. Sprout Social
6. Medallia
7. UserZoom
8. Alchemer
9. In-app message delivery
10. On-premise AI platform
11. Figma
12. JIRA
13. Metrics dashboard

USE CASES

1. First-time user attempts to set up a new account
2. User attempts to deposit
 - a. Fail alt flow + customer support
3. User attempts to withdraw funds (variants by amount and bet type)
 - a. Fail alt flow + customer support

STAKEHOLDERS

1. Executive leadership team
2. Initiative senior managers
3. Legal & compliance
4. Marketing
5. Customer Support
6. Data & Analytics
7. Design
8. Development



PHASE 1: ESTABLISH BASELINES

GOAL

Fully examine the current state of the payment landscape, identify problem areas, establish a measurable baseline for comparison



RESULT

1. Directional categories of pain points
2. Success metrics for ongoing assessment



PHASE 1: detail

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. Where do we stand now?
2. Where do we think the problems are?
3. Do we have reliable data on customer satisfaction?

ACTIVITIES & MILESTONES

1. Project kickoff
2. Detail payment transaction flows
3. Data analysis to determine current state*
4. Conduct CSAT surveys as needed
5. Summarize pain points
6. Stakeholder review findings and initial hypotheses

DATA SOURCES

1. App & Web metrics (e.g. pathing, bounce, repeat visits)
2. Transaction counts and error logs (e.g. # deposits)
3. Customer support reports for issue type and resolution
4. Marketing and UX research (e.g. churn study)
5. App store reviews (e.g. keywords by star rating)
6. Social listening (e.g. Reddit, X Customer Support, Facebook)
7. User sat metrics (e.g. CSAT, NPS)
8. Third-party sources (e.g. PayNearMe surveys)

ESTIMATE

2 Researchers, 3 Weeks

*See sample data assessment



PHASE 1: SPECULATIVE FINDINGS

- 57% of withdrawal tickets for first-time users are resolved with information
- 36% of app store reviews with 1-3 stars are related to withdrawal time

Working hypothesis:

Some first-time, casual bettors experience frustration with withdrawals because of unclear expectations for timing.



PHASE 2: PINPOINT PAIN POINTS

GOAL

Isolate pain points then prioritize the issues most impactful on revenue and responsible gaming behavior.



RESULT

1. Prioritized pain points
2. UX Requirements



PHASE 2: PINPOINT PAIN POINTS

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. How big is the problem?
2. Exactly where is the point of failure?
3. How much does this impact revenue targets and responsible gaming?

ESTIMATE

2 Researchers
2 Weeks per iteration

ACTIVITIES & MILESTONES

1. Kickoff
2. **Quantitative customer surveys to measure issues and sentiment**
3. **Remote usability testing* to pinpoint points of failure**
4. **Impact assessments to link pain points to churn, responsible gaming behavior**
5. Review findings with stakeholders to prioritize issues
6. Deliver UX requirements

* See [sample usability test plan](#)



PHASE 2: EXAMPLE FINDINGS

- “18% of first-time users experience discomfort with the withdrawal process ***because of a lack of accurate expectations.***”
- “26% of first-time, casual bettors would leave the site if asked for 2 or more of ***the following pieces of personal information.***”

Revised Hypothesis: A stepped withdrawal flow with simplified information and context-aware help would increase satisfaction and reduce customer support tickets.



PHASE 3: MODEL SOLUTIONS

GOAL

Working with Design, perform iterative testing (RITE Method) to quickly prototype solutions to the key paint points



RESULT

Design specifications for development sprints



PHASE 3: MODEL SOLUTIONS

ACTIVITIES

1. Stakeholder & team kickoff, consensus on scope
2. Core research and design teams perform iterative prototyping & evaluation until desired results are achieved ([See RITE Method](#))
3. Competitor & comparative analysis of target paths for best practices
4. Write design specifications for development changes
5. Rinse and Repeat through prioritized pain points
6. Stakeholder & team review findings, agreement to proceed to development

ESTIMATE

2 Researchers
2 Designers
1-2 Product Managers
1-2 Weeks per iteration

[See RITE Method](#)



PHASE 4: POINT RELEASES & MONITOR SUCCESS METRICS

GOAL

Following launch of the enhancements as incremental point releases, review key success metrics with leadership on a weekly then monthly basis.



RESULT

10-20% lift on success metrics after 6 months

20-40% lift after 12 months



PHASE 4: POINT RELEASES & MONITOR SUCCESS METRICS

ACTIVITIES

1. Launch critical updates
2. A/B Testing on non-transactional updates
3. Monthly stakeholder review of key metrics
4. Continue research/design/development iterations for improvements

MONTHLY SUCCESS METRICS

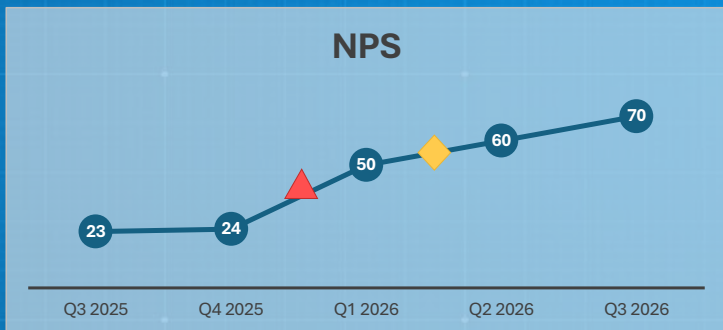
- a. Monthly Active Players
- b. Revenue
- c. Customer support tickets
- d. App store reviews
- e. CSAT scores
- f. Social listening
- g. App & web usage metrics
- h. Churn



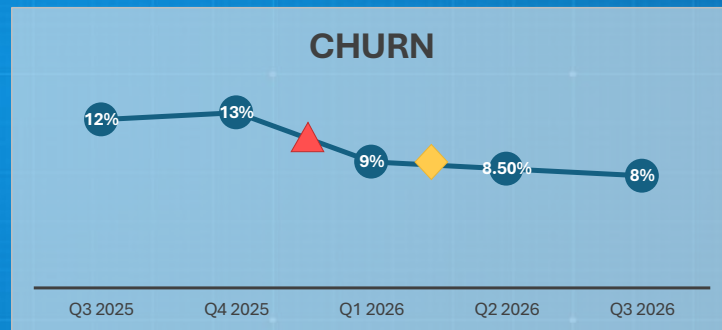
Q3 2026 MONTHLY REVIEW

Impacts:

- ▲ FanDuel Sportsbook & Casino Release 2.14 introduced **withdrawal widget**
- ◆ FanDuel Casino Release 3.1 introduced **fast-tracked customer support**



NPS rose 16.7%



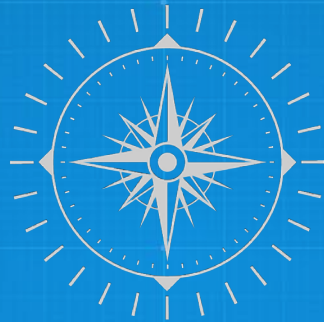
Churn rate dropped by 5.8%



YEAR-END REVIEW

Improved user experience has resulted in significant improvements in key success metrics

	Q3 2025	Q4 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	MoM	YoY
NPS	23	24	50	60	70	+16.7%	+204%
CHURN	12%	13%	9%	8.5%	8%	-5.88%	-33.3%
MAPs	2.75M	2.82M	3.2M	3.6M	3.8M	+5.56%	+38.2%
REVENUE	3.66B	3.72B	3.98B	4.22B	4.78B	+6.03%	+15.3%
CSAT	55	58	65	72	75	+4.17%	+36.6%
CS Tickets	72%	68%	60%	50%	45%	-10%	-37%



Let's get there together!

ADDENDUM

SOURCES

- Flutter Annual Report, 2024
- "iGaming Payment Optimization is Key to Player Retention", 2023, Betting Hero
- Deposits and Withdrawals Among Sportsbook's Biggest Customer Service Issues, 2022, gamingtoday.com
- Online Sports-Betting Apps Face Customer Complaints Over Delays Withdrawing Funds, WSJ, 2022
- Players Gonna Pay: Characterizing gamblers and gambling-related harm with payments transaction data. Ghaharian et. al, Computers in Human Behavior, 2023



Example Data Assessment, Phase 1

Review customer support tickets to identify critical issues and success metrics

1. Pull reports from the last 6 months on payment-related tickets.
 - a. Assess proportion of tickets related to payment, deposit, or withdrawal
 - b. Assess median resolution time
 - c. Assess resolution types
2. Pull reports on tickets related to customer satisfaction and trust (e.g. keywords 'trust' or category 'customer sat')
3. Identify issues for further evaluation (e.g. "First-time withdrawal - dissatisfaction with turn-around time")
 - a. **Example metric: "57% of withdrawal tickets for first-time users are resolved with information."**
4. Success Metrics
 - a. Reduce number of payment, deposit, and withdrawal tickets
 - b. Reduce resolution time
 - c. Increase satisfactory resolutions
5. Ongoing activities
 - a. Assess trends monthly
 - b. Where beneficial, write new self-service content for apps and web



Example Usability Test Plan

Hypothesis

Study of customer support tickets and app store reviews indicates that some first-time, casual bettors experience a high degree of frustration with the withdrawal process based upon an unclear expectation for timing. This study will clearly indicate areas of confusion with the current withdrawal functionality.

Audience

- First-time users, small bets
- Sample size: 12
- Recruitment: UserTesting panel from targeted states, following FanDuel demographics
 - Age 23-34: (6), 35-44: (6)
 - Sex: Male: (8), Female: 4

Goals & Measurement

- Primary goal: Measure how accurately users predict withdrawal timing after completion of withdrawal request
- Secondary goal: Identify areas of confusion or failure with the withdrawal transaction

Methodology

- Recorded, remote observation of users attempting to withdraw funds.
- Remote testing platform UserTesting
- Incentives handled by UserTesting
- Analysis: Descriptive statistics and thematic analysis

Scenarios & Stimuli

- Use Case: First-time user attempts to withdraw funds
- Test people using a development platform with a mock user account OR create a high-fidelity Figma prototype that mirrors the withdrawal process

Test Metrics

- Task Completion
- Error Type
- User Queries, e.g. "How long do you think it will take before your withdrawal is available?"

Test Instruments

- Permission Form
- Survey Questions

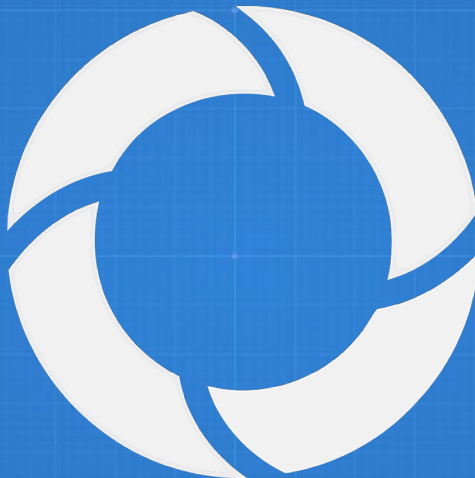
Schedule

- Test Design & Approval: 3 days
- Test Programming: 1 days
- Produce test prototype: 4 days
- Collect data: 3 days
- Analyze data: 3 days
- Total Estimate: 10 days

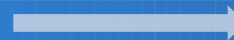


RITE Method

PROTOTYPE



EVALUATE



Exit the cycle when targets are met

1-2 weeks for 3-4 design/research iterations